

# ROBIN YIFAN LUO

Personal Website | [yifanluo@uw.edu](mailto:yifanluo@uw.edu)

## EDUCATION

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| University of Washington, Seattle, Ph.D. in Finance                | <i>Expected June 2027</i> |
| University of British Columbia, M.Sc. in Finance                   | <i>2021</i>               |
| Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, M.Sc. in Economics | <i>2019</i>               |
| University of Nottingham, B.Sc. with Honours in Economics          | <i>2018</i>               |

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Corporate Finance, Financial Intermediation, Industrial Organization

## JOB MARKET PAPER

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**Misallocation in Banking**, solo-authored *Draft available upon request*

I develop and estimate a two-sided oligopolistic model of U.S. banking to measure how uneven bank pricing power misallocates deposits and loans. Estimated annual welfare losses range from \$1.3 to \$3.1 billion (2019 dollars), with deposit-loan complementarities offsetting a substantial share. The framework also evaluates how mergers, monetary tightening, and banking stress shift banks relative to efficient marginal-surplus benchmarks.

## PUBLICATION

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**In Search of a Unicorn: Dynamic Agency with Endogenous Investment Opportunities**, with Felix Zhiyu Feng and Beatrice Michaeli

*Journal of Accounting and Economics*, 2024. [[SSRN](#)]

Develops a dynamic contracting model in which privately observed opportunities arrive through costly search. The optimal contract generates time-varying investment thresholds, internal search charges, and empirically testable overinvestment patterns.

## WORKING PAPERS

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**The Optimal Schedules of Incentives and Cash Flows**, with Felix Zhiyu Feng and Mark M. Westerfield

Studies delegated management when observable output combines investment in durable asset quality and instantaneous effort. Optimal incentives begin back-loaded and can become front-loaded as promised future incentives accumulate, generating cash-flow mean reversion and implications for the duration of incentives.

**Clientele Specialization, Stable Capital, and Value in Asset Management**, with Hossein Poorvasei

*Draft available upon request*

Using 4,391 U.S. separately managed account products, documents that clientele specialization predicts more durable funding, more stable exposures, and higher gross-of-fee alpha. A model links relationship-specific investment to funding stability, scale, and the division of gains between managers and clients.

## WORK IN PROGRESS

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**Money-Market Capacity and the Funding Channel of Monetary Policy**, with Germán Gutiérrez and Hossein Poorvasei

Shows that the cost banks pay to replace deposits with wholesale funding during monetary tightening is not a fixed friction but depends on money-market capacity — it rises more steeply when capacity is scarce, only for unsecured funding, and passes through to bank lending.

**The Industrial Organization of Safe Savings**, with Germán Gutiérrez and Hossein Poorvasei

Shows that deposit betas are equilibrium outcomes of a market in which differentiated bank products compete with money funds, Treasury bills, and cash. Estimating deposit demand on the universe of U.S. banks, finds that the pass-through of policy rates to the marginal value of deposit funding is far below one, and that competition within a bank's own product menu, more so than rivalry between banks, generates most of the observed pass-through.

**Production Functions in Asset Management**, with Ahmed Guecioueur

## TEACHING AND STUDENT ENGAGEMENT

Teaching Assistant, University of Washington

2022–2026

- EMBA 520: Financial Management, for Jonathan Karpoff
- EMBA 540: International Finance, for Stephan Siegel
- TMMBA 501: Microeconomics for Technology Managers, for Alexis León
- Median rating of 4.7/5.0 across seven Executive MBA sections (range 4.5–4.9). Recipient of EMBA Teaching Recognition Award.

**Teaching interests:** Corporate finance, applied financial markets, investment theory, valuation and financial modeling, financial institutions and banking, international finance, financial accounting, microeconomics, statistics, ML/AI.

## PRESENTATIONS

*Conferences and invited seminars (\* presented by coauthor)*

**2026:** Finance Theory Group Fall Meeting\*, FMA Annual Meeting, FIRS Conference\*, Econometric Society North American Summer Meeting\*

**2025:** Financial Theory Group Summer School, Southwest Finance Association, Eastern Finance Association\*

**2023:** CES North America Conference, Journal of Accounting and Economics conference\*, Organizational Economics Workshop\*, 33rd Stony Brook International Conference on Game Theory\*

**2022:** Financial Markets and Corporate Governance Conference\*, Research Symposium on Finance and Economics, Asia-Pacific Association of Derivatives, Australasian Finance & Banking Conference, China International Conference in Finance\*, HKUST Accounting Research Symposium\*

## SERVICES

Ph.D. Student Mentor, UW Foster

2024–2026

Doctoral Business Students Association Representative, UW Foster

2025

Co-Organizer, Finance Ph.D. Brownbag, UW Foster

2022–2024

## AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Dean's Achievement Award, UW Foster

EMBA Teaching Recognition Award, UW Foster

UW Ph.D. Fellowship

## SKILLS AND INTERESTS

**Programming:** R, MATLAB, Python, Stata, SQL,  $\text{\LaTeX}$

**Languages:** Mandarin (native), English (fluent), French (basic), Cantonese (basic)

**Interests:** Hiking, bouldering, concerts, acoustic guitar

## REFERENCES

**Mark M. Westerfield (Chair)**

Professor of Finance and Business Economics, Michael G. Foster Endowed Professor  
University of Washington  
[mwesterf@uw.edu](mailto:mwesterf@uw.edu)

**Philip Bond**

Professor of Finance and Business Economics, Edward E. Carlson Distinguished Professor in Business Administration  
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**Germán Gutiérrez**

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**Felix Feng**

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